

and First Responder Item there is a “Tab Bar Controller” instead of the “View” item. This is where all the UI magic happens. The Tab Bar Controller is a container which has multiple View Collections inside it. By Default it comes loaded it with two of them.

Now that we understand the basics of the “Tab-Bar” Applications the most natural question to ask is how to add more tabs?

7.3 Adding tab bar items

Open your library window inside the interface builder and drag and drop “Tab Bar Item” on the pre existing Tab Bar view. Now select the Tab Bar item that you have just dragged and drop and open its Attribute Inspector window. From here you can change its title and icon displayed via the “Title” and “Image” attribute. Apple makes your job easier and gives you pre-

designed combinations for common tasks. For this you will need to change the identifier setting, for the purpose of illustration let us set it to “Search”.

You will immediately notice that your third bar is now by default called “Search” and has a Magnifying glass icon next to it. The badge attribute that you see in the inspector window is super script text badge that appears next to your icons. If you wish fill it with a number like say “3” or you can even leave it blank.

In your interface builder you can open each of the views separately and modify their appearances and behaviour even simultaneously. Yes you can actually have more than one “View” window open at the same time.

Now that we have change the identifier to “search”, let us actually add some functionality of search to its respective view. We will begin by adding a new XIB file, this can be accomplished by right-clicking on the resources



the alternate view of your two-tab application